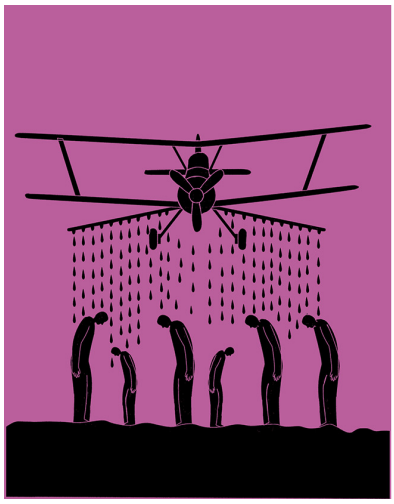


THE CHEMICAL BARRAGE HAS BEEN HURLED AGAINST THE FABRIC OF LIFE

THE LEGACY OF PESTICIDES

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Rachel Carson (1907–64)

BEFORE

1854 Henry David Thoreau's book *Walden* describes a social experiment to live the simple life in tune with nature. It is seen as an inspiration for the environmentalist movement.

1949 *A Sand County Almanac* by Aldo Leopold proposes a deep ecology of people living in harmony with the land.

AFTER

1970 The US establishes the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA).

1989 Bill McKibben's book *The End of Nature* highlights the dangers of global warming.

2006 The documentary *An Inconvenient Truth* records former US vice president Al Gore's efforts to educate the public about climate change.

Arguably the most revered and influential book ever published on the subject of environmentalism, *Silent Spring* garnered a huge amount of publicity when it was released in 1962. It galvanized the fledgling